Link Text

Inclusion Toolkit

What is it for?

Many screen reader users navigate websites by opening a list of only the links on a page. If your links just say 'Click here' or 'Read more', their list will just read out, 'Click here, Click here, Read more'. That doesn't help them find what they are looking for. Good link text makes sense all by itself, even if you hide the rest of the page.

Good link text doesn't need any special code. It's all about writing clear, helpful words, and everyone benefits from that, not just screen reader users.

How to support it

Write links that tell the user exactly where they are going, what they're doing, or what they are opening

- Be descriptive. Use 'Read our 2024 report', not 'To see our new report, click here'
- Avoid raw uniform resource locators (URLs). Screen readers will read out the whole address, including slashes and symbols

Users jumping from link to link do not hear the surrounding text. They only hear the words that you made clickable

Useful Links

Writing Meaningful Link Text
WebAIM: Links and Hypertext
W3C: Link Purpose